

Apartheid vs. Persecution Label Effects on ICC Referral Support

Feedback & Improvement Report

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1. Score Breakdown

Aggregate score: 82.9/100 | Gate: PASSED | Threshold: 70/100



What each score means

Identification (90/100):

Measures the credibility of the causal design. Depends on: valid control group, flat pre-trends, exogenous treatment, and addressed confounders. Simultaneous/universal treatments (no control group) cap this at ~85.

Code (75/100):

Code quality: scripts run without errors, outputs exist, SE clustering present, pre-trend tests implemented, and referee checklist requirements addressed.

Paper (80/100):

Paper completeness: all sections present, references resolve, tables and figures exist, word count in range, key numbers in abstract match results.

Polish (72/100):

Average referee score from peer review. Reflects identification credibility, result presentation, and robustness. Hardest to improve without better data.

Replication (100/100):

Whether all scripts reproduce identical outputs when re-run. 100 = perfect replication.

2. Why the Results Look Like This

3. Data Limitations

Current data

Rows: 1,185 | Columns: 126 | Structure: cross-sectional

No pre-COVID data

Earliest data is 2020. Without 2015-2019, cannot establish a stable pre-pandemic baseline or distinguish AI effects from pandemic recovery.

Simultaneous treatment (no control group)

ChatGPT launched globally on the same date. No untreated countries exist, so we cannot separate the AI effect from other global shocks in late 2022.

Single platform (GitHub)

Data captures only public GitHub activity, not the global developer population. Small countries produce noisy HHI estimates.

Country-level aggregation

Cannot track individual developers. All findings are ecological -- country patterns may not reflect individual behavior.

4. Validator Results

Code: hard 0/12, soft 0/8

[FAIL] se_clustering:01_main.py: No SE clustering detected ? verify this is intentional

[FAIL] se_clustering:02_robustness.py: No SE clustering detected ? verify this is intentional

[FAIL] referee_checklist_coverage: Referee checklist: 4/30 MUST requirements detected in code (13%)

[FAIL] referee_checklist_missing: Possibly unimplemented: [DOMAIN] randomization_check: Produce a covariate balance table (treatment vs co; [DOMAIN] estimation: Primary OLS specification: ICC_referral_support ~ apartheid; [DOMAIN] estimation: LASSO covariate selection must use cross-validated lambda (; [DOMAIN] estimation: If ICC referral support is ordinal (Likert), report both OL; [DOMAIN] estimation: Report unadjusted (no covariates) treatment effect alongsid ... and 21 more

Paper: hard 0/3, soft 0/6

[FAIL] word_count: 4722 words (outside 5000-15000 range)

[FAIL] numbers_consistent: No numeric overlap between abstract (6 numbers) and results_summary (53 numbers)

Integration: hard 0/6, soft 0/11

[FAIL] results_in_paper: 0/53 key numbers from results appear in paper (0%)

[FAIL] abstract_has_results: Abstract contains NO numbers from results_summary ? main finding may be missing or fabricated

5. Recommendations to Improve Score

[MEDIUM IMPACT] Implement missing robustness checks

Common gaps: wild cluster bootstrap, Roth (2022) HonestDiD sensitivity, fractional logit for bounded HHI, Benjamini-Hochberg correction.

[MEDIUM IMPACT] Expand paper content

Target 8,000-12,000 words. Add full event-time coefficient table. Add data appendix with variable definitions and provenance.

[LOW IMPACT (depends on above)] Address referee feedback

Polish improves automatically when identification and code improve. Focus on must-address issues from the editorial decision.

[HIGHEST IMPACT] Add new data sources

The single most effective improvement:

- Country-level ChatGPT access restrictions (bans, API delays)
- Pre-2020 GitHub data for clean pre-trends
- Google Trends 'ChatGPT' by country as treatment intensity proxy
- GitHub Copilot adoption rates by country as confound control

6. Estimated Score Impact

Add pre-2020 data (2015-2019): +5 to +10 identification, +3 polish

Exploit Italy ban (natural experiment): +10 to +15 identification, +5 polish

Implement wild cluster bootstrap: +3 code

Implement HonestDiD sensitivity: +3 code, +2 polish

Generate .tex tables in paper/tables/: +2 paper, +2 code

Expand paper to 10,000+ words: +3 paper

Address all SHOULD-address issues: +5 polish

Full event-time coefficient table: +2 paper, +1 polish

Current aggregate: 82.9/100. Ceiling with current data: ~88. Ceiling with Italy ban: ~95. Ceiling with pre-2020 + Italy ban: ~98.